Internet Crimes and Cyber Security

Week: 05 **Session: 24**

Topic :Understanding Social Media Crimes

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Understanding Social Media Crimes and Fake News

Concepts to be covered

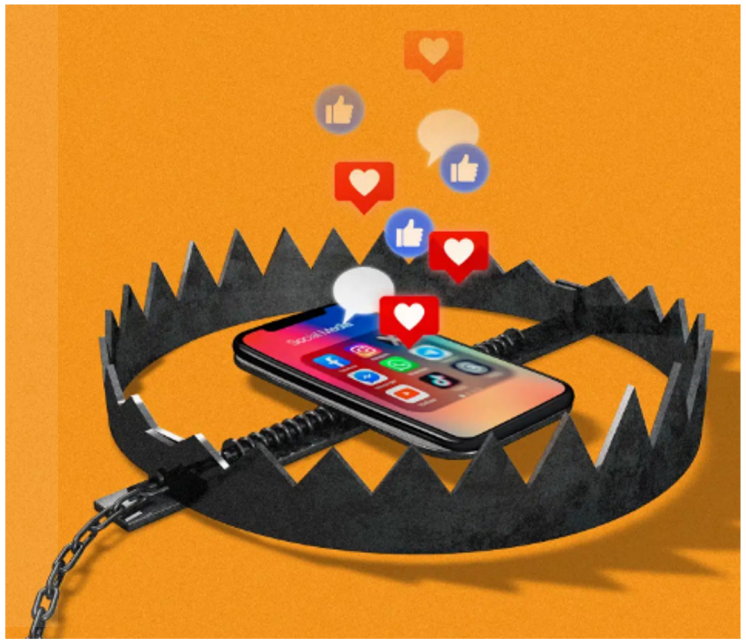
1. Define social media crimes
2. Identify major Social Media crime categories
3. Introduction to SOCMINT (Social Media Intelligence) for Investigation
4. SOCMINT Case study using Maltego
5. Understanding fake news mechanisms and propagation
6. AI Tools for fake news detection

Understanding Social Media Crimes and Fake News

Define social media crimes

at is Social Media : Social media refers to interactive digital platforms psites, apps) where users create and share content (text, photos, videos), n online communities, and network, enabling instant communication, nection, and information exchange globally. It's a form of mass munication facilitating virtual interactions and the building of online al networks through features like user profiles and content feeds, used for onal, professional, and community purposes

cial Media Crimes : Social media crimes are illegal acts using **ial platforms for harm, including cyberbullying, stalking, fraud e phishing or identity theft), impersonation, and spreading icious content (hate speech, misinformation, child abuse terial).** These crimes exploit social connections and personal data financial gain, harassment, revenge, or disruption, often involving e profiles, hacking, or exploiting vulnerabilities to steal info or nage reputations



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2. Major Social Media crime categories

A. Interpersonal Harassment:

Cyberstalking & Bullying: Using digital platforms to harass, intimidate, or threaten individuals. This includes sending abusive messages or spreading false rumors to cause humiliation.

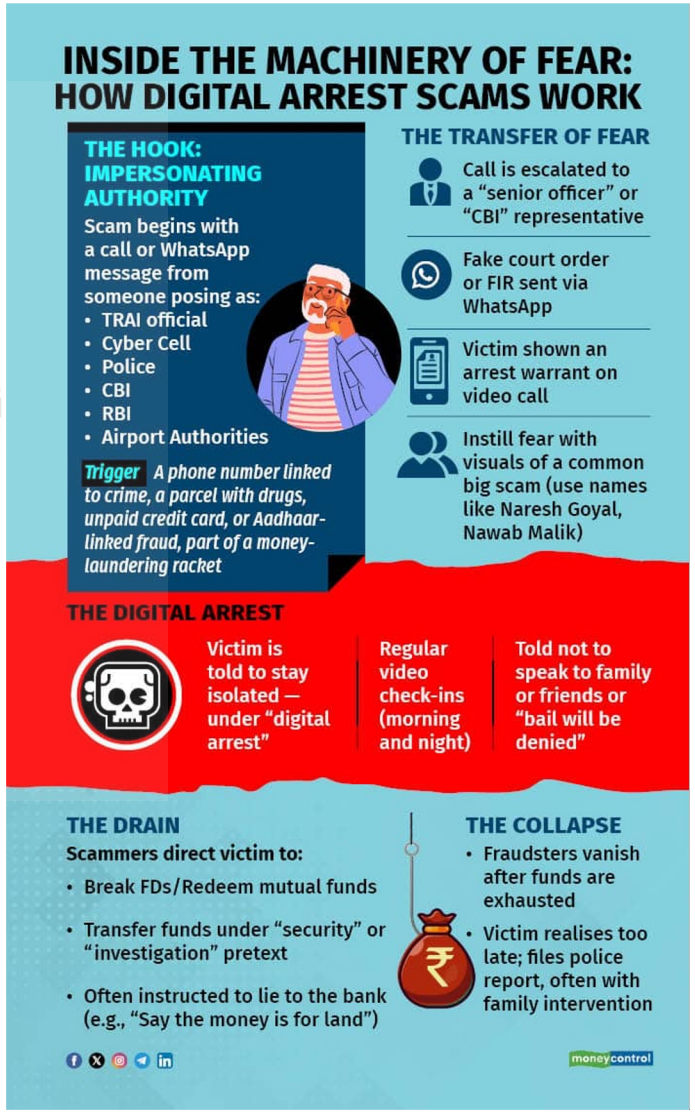
Online Grooming: Adults befriending minors for sexual or illegal purposes.

B. Fraud and Financial Scams:

Digital Arrest Scams: A major trend in 2025 where scammers impersonate law enforcement on video calls to "digitally arrest" victims, demanding money to resolve fake cases.

Romance & Sympathy Fraud: Creating fake emotional bonds to trick victims into transferring money for supposed emergencies.

Phishing: Using deceptive links or messages to steal login credentials and banking details.



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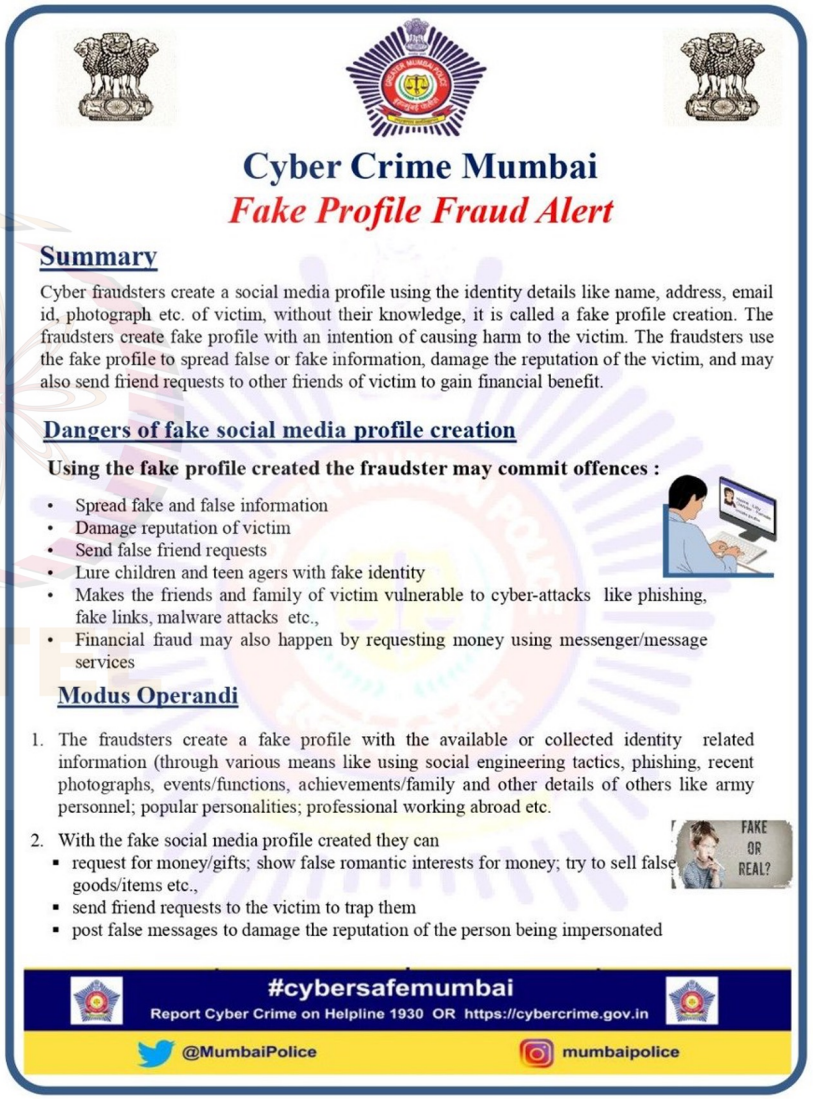
2. Identify major crime categories

C. Identity-Related Crimes:
Impersonation: Creating fake profiles to damage someone's reputation or trick their contacts.
Catfishing: Adopting a false identity to lure someone into a relationship or for financial gain.

D. Illegal Transactions & Distribution:
Buying Illegal Goods: Using platforms to purchase drugs or other banned products.
Distributing Prohibited Content: Sharing non-consensual sexual images, animal torture, or extremist material.



Cyber Crime Mumbai

Fake Profile Fraud Alert

Summary

Cyber fraudsters create a social media profile using the identity details like name, address, email id, photograph etc. of victim, without their knowledge, it is called a fake profile creation. The fraudsters create fake profile with an intention of causing harm to the victim. The fraudsters use the fake profile to spread false or fake information, damage the reputation of the victim, and may also send friend requests to other friends of victim to gain financial benefit.

Dangers of fake social media profile creation

Using the fake profile created the fraudster may commit offences :

- Spread fake and false information
- Damage reputation of victim
- Send false friend requests
- Lure children and teen agers with fake identity
- Makes the friends and family of victim vulnerable to cyber-attacks like phishing, fake links, malware attacks etc.,
- Financial fraud may also happen by requesting money using messenger/message services

Modus Operandi

1. The fraudsters create a fake profile with the available or collected identity related information (through various means like using social engineering tactics, phishing, recent photographs, events/functions, achievements/family and other details of others like army personnel; popular personalities; professional working abroad etc.
2. With the fake social media profile created they can
   - request for money/gifts; show false romantic interests for money; try to sell false goods/items etc.,
   - send friend requests to the victim to trap them
   - post false messages to damage the reputation of the person being impersonated

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Report Cyber Crime on Helpline 1930 OR https://cybercrime.gov.in

@MumbaiPolice

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Thank You